

Recruitment & Onboarding Policy

Narsimha Tech | Effective: 1 January 2025 | Internal Use Only

1. Purpose & Scope

1.1 Purpose

This Recruitment & Onboarding Policy describes how Narsimha Tech sources, assesses, hires, and onboards talent, ensuring a consistent, fair, and high-quality experience for candidates and a smooth transition into productive employment for new joiners.

1.2 Scope

This policy applies to all recruitment activity for Permanent Full-Time, Permanent Part-Time, and Fixed-Term Contract roles across all Narsimha Tech locations. Engagement of consultants and contractors follows a separate Procurement-led process and is not covered by this policy, except where explicitly cross-referenced.

1.3 Guiding Principles

Recruitment at Narsimha Tech is guided by: merit-based selection; consistency and fairness across candidates; a positive candidate experience regardless of outcome; and compliance with the Equal Opportunity commitments described in the Employee Handbook.

1.4 Roles in the Recruitment Process

- **Talent Acquisition (TA) Team:** Owns the end-to-end recruitment process, sourcing, and candidate experience.
- **Hiring Manager:** Defines role requirements, participates in interviews, and makes the final hiring recommendation.
- **Interview Panel:** Assesses candidates against defined competencies and provides structured feedback.
- **HR Business Partner:** Reviews offer terms for consistency with internal equity and policy, and supports onboarding.

2. Workforce Planning & Requisition

2.1 Headcount Approval

All new or replacement hiring requires an approved headcount requisition, raised by the hiring manager in the Applicant Tracking System (ATS) and approved by the department head and Finance (for budget confirmation) before sourcing begins.

2.2 Job Description Standards

Job descriptions must clearly state required skills, experience, and competencies, avoid unnecessarily exclusionary requirements (e.g., inflated years-of-experience requirements not genuinely necessary for the role), and be reviewed periodically for inclusive language consistent with the Employee Handbook's Diversity, Equity & Inclusion commitments.

2.3 Internal Mobility First

Consistent with the Employee Handbook, Section 7.6, internal job openings are published on the intranet for at least 2 weeks before external advertising, giving existing employees the first opportunity to apply.

2.4 Sourcing Channels

The TA team sources candidates through the Company careers page, professional networking platforms, recruitment agencies (for hard-to-fill or senior roles, subject to an approved agency agreement), campus hiring programmes, and the Employee Referral Programme described in the Employee Handbook, Section 12.2.

3. Candidate Assessment & Selection

3.1 Structured Interview Process

All candidates for a given role are assessed against the same defined set of competencies, using structured interview guides prepared by the TA team and hiring manager, to support consistent and fair comparison across candidates.

3.2 Interview Stages

A typical interview process includes: an initial TA screening call; one or more technical or functional assessments appropriate to the role (which may include a take-home exercise, live coding session, or case study); a hiring manager interview; and, for senior roles, a panel interview including cross-functional stakeholders.

3.3 Take-Home and Live Technical Assessments

Technical assessments must be proportionate in time commitment to the seniority of the role and must not require the candidate to produce material that could be used as free labour for actual Company work; assessments are reviewed by the TA team periodically to ensure they remain fair and reasonably scoped.

3.4 Diverse Interview Panels

Where feasible, interview panels include diverse representation (in terms of gender, function, and seniority) to reduce the risk of individual bias affecting the hiring decision, consistent with the Employee Handbook's inclusive hiring commitment.

3.5 Candidate Feedback and Scorecards

Each interviewer submits a structured scorecard in the ATS within 2 business days of the interview, and the hiring manager consolidates feedback before making a hiring recommendation; verbal-only feedback without a documented scorecard is not sufficient to support a hiring decision.

3.6 Avoiding Bias

Interviewers must avoid questions related to protected characteristics (marital status, family planning intentions, religion, etc.) that are not genuinely relevant to assessing job-related competencies, consistent with the Equal Opportunity commitment in the Employee Handbook.

3.7 Candidate Communication

The TA team commits to communicating an outcome (positive or negative) to every candidate who reaches the interview stage within 5 business days of the final interview, recognising that candidate experience

reflects on the Company's employer brand regardless of outcome.

4. Background Verification

4.1 Scope of Verification

All offers of employment are subject to satisfactory background verification, covering identity, education, prior employment, and, for specific roles (e.g., finance, IT administrator access), additional checks such as credit history or criminal record checks where permitted by local law and proportionate to the role.

4.2 Process

Background verification is conducted by an approved third-party verification agency, initiated after a conditional offer is extended and accepted, and is expected to complete within 2-3 weeks, though this may vary depending on the complexity of the candidate's history and the responsiveness of prior employers/institutions.

4.3 Discrepancies

Any material discrepancy identified during verification (e.g., a fabricated qualification, materially misrepresented employment history) is reviewed by HR and Legal and may result in withdrawal of the offer or, if the employee has already joined, may be treated as a basis for termination, consistent with the Terms of Employment.

4.4 Candidate Notification

Where a discrepancy is identified, the candidate is given a reasonable opportunity to explain before a final decision is made, consistent with principles of fairness applied throughout the hiring process.

5. Offer Management

5.1 Offer Approval

All offers must be approved by the hiring manager, department head, and HR Business Partner before being extended, with compensation benchmarked against the relevant salary band and internal equity considerations for the role and grade.

5.2 Offer Letter Content

Offer letters specify: employment category (per the Terms of Employment, Section 2); compensation structure; reporting line; work location; probation terms; and any role-specific conditions (e.g., a non-compete covenant for senior roles, per the Terms of Employment, Section 8.6).

5.3 Offer Validity and Negotiation

Offers are typically valid for 7 calendar days from issuance; reasonable negotiation on compensation or start date is accommodated within the hiring manager's and HR's delegated authority, escalated to the department head for any request beyond standard parameters.

5.4 Conditional Offers

Offers are generally conditional upon satisfactory background verification (Section 4) and, where applicable, medical fitness assessment for roles with specific physical requirements.

5.5 Counter-Offer Situations

Where a candidate discloses a competing offer or a counter-offer from their current employer, the hiring manager and TA team may, within delegated authority, adjust the offer to remain competitive, but are not obligated to do so, and should avoid an offer process that appears to reward gamesmanship over genuine role fit.

6. Pre-Joining Formalities

6.1 Document Collection

Candidates who accept an offer must submit required documentation (identity proof, educational certificates, prior employment relieving letters, and bank details) through the pre-joining portal before their date of joining, to enable timely payroll and benefits setup.

6.2 Relieving Letter from Previous Employer

Candidates are expected to serve their notice period with their current employer and obtain a relieving letter before joining; exceptions (e.g., joining during a notice period with mutual agreement from the previous employer) require HR Director approval and a clear understanding of any associated risk.

6.3 Pre-Joining Engagement

The TA team and hiring manager maintain light-touch engagement with the candidate between offer acceptance and joining date (e.g., a welcome call, sharing onboarding logistics) to maintain engagement and reduce the risk of an accepted offer falling through.

6.4 IT and Workspace Provisioning

IT provisions the new joiner's laptop, accounts, and system access in advance of the joining date based on the role profile, following the Joiner-Mover-Leaver process described in the IT & Information Security Policy, so that the employee is fully equipped from Day 1.

7. Onboarding Programme

7.1 Day 1 Orientation

New joiners attend a structured Day 1 orientation covering: Company overview, mission and values; an overview of key policies (Terms of Employment, Employee Handbook, Code of Conduct); IT setup and security training enrolment; and benefits enrolment guidance.

7.2 First Week

During the first week, new joiners complete mandatory compliance training (Code of Conduct, POSH awareness, data privacy, security awareness, per the relevant policies), meet their assigned buddy (Section 7.5), and begin role-specific onboarding led by the hiring manager and team.

7.3 30-60-90 Day Plan

Hiring managers are expected to prepare a 30-60-90 day onboarding plan for each new joiner, outlining expected ramp-up milestones, key stakeholders to meet, and initial deliverables, reviewed collaboratively with the new joiner in their first week.

7.4 Onboarding Check-Ins

HR conducts a 30-day check-in survey and a 90-day check-in conversation with each new joiner to gather feedback on the onboarding experience and flag any early concerns, distinct from the monthly probation check-ins described in the Terms of Employment, Section 4.2.

7.5 Buddy Programme

Each new joiner is assigned a peer buddy for their first 90 days, as described in the Employee Handbook, Section 12.5, to provide informal day-to-day support distinct from the formal line-management relationship.

7.6 Role-Specific Onboarding

For technical roles, onboarding includes structured access to relevant Centre of Excellence learning paths, codebase walkthroughs, and shadowing of more experienced team members on live client work before taking on independent delivery responsibility.

7.7 Client-Facing Onboarding

For roles requiring early client interaction, the hiring manager ensures the new joiner receives a briefing on the relevant client relationship, account history, and any client-specific protocols before their first client-facing interaction.

8. Diversity & Inclusive Hiring Practices

8.1 Commitment

Recruitment practices are designed to support the Company's broader Diversity, Equity & Inclusion commitments described in the Employee Handbook, Section 11.

8.2 Inclusive Sourcing

The TA team actively sources from a diverse range of channels, including partnerships with organisations supporting underrepresented groups in technology, to build a diverse candidate pipeline rather than relying solely on networks that may inadvertently reproduce existing workforce demographics.

8.3 Accessibility in the Recruitment Process

Candidates requiring accommodations during the interview process (e.g., for a disability) should notify the TA team, who will coordinate reasonable adjustments (such as additional time for assessments or alternative interview formats) without this being visible to, or influencing the judgement of, the interview panel.

8.4 Campus and Early Career Hiring

Campus hiring programmes follow a structured, standardised assessment process across all participating institutions, designed to ensure consistency and fairness regardless of which campus a candidate is sourced from.

9. Employee Referral Programme

9.1 Eligibility

Current employees (excluding those on the TA team for roles they are actively recruiting, to avoid a conflict of interest) may refer candidates for open roles via the intranet referral portal.

9.2 Referral Bonus

A referral bonus is paid after the referred candidate completes a defined minimum service period (typically 3 months), with bonus amounts varying by role seniority as published on the intranet, consistent with the Employee Handbook, Section 12.2.

9.3 Referring Family Members

Employees referring a close family member must disclose the relationship at the point of referral; the referred family member's interview process and any subsequent reporting relationship are managed consistent with the Conflict of Interest provisions in the Code of Conduct & Business Ethics Policy.

9.4 Referral Programme Integrity

Referral bonuses are not payable where the referring employee had any role in interviewing or making the hiring decision for the candidate they referred, to maintain the integrity of the assessment process.

10. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How long does the typical recruitment process take from application to offer?

A: This varies by role seniority and complexity, but the TA team targets 3-4 weeks from initial screening to offer for most individual contributor roles, and may take longer for senior or specialised roles requiring additional panel coordination.

Q: Can a hiring manager skip the structured interview process for an internal transfer they already know well?

A: A lighter-touch process may be appropriate for internal transfers, but some structured assessment of role-relevant competencies, documented in the ATS, is still expected to ensure fairness and a documented record of the decision.

Q: What happens if background verification is still in progress on the candidate's planned joining date?

A: The candidate may still join with the offer remaining conditional upon successful completion of verification; HR will clarify the specific arrangement and any implications if verification subsequently reveals a discrepancy.

Q: Is there a cooling-off period before a rejected candidate can reapply?

A: There is no fixed cooling-off period; a candidate may reapply for a different or the same role in the future, and the TA team will assess the application on its merits, taking into account any specific feedback from the prior process where relevant.

11. Recruitment Agency & Vendor Management

11.1 Approved Agency Panel

Recruitment agencies engaged to support hiring must be on the Company's approved agency panel, managed by Procurement in partnership with the TA team, with standard commercial terms (typically a percentage of first-year CTC, payable upon successful confirmation past probation) agreed in advance.

11.2 Engaging a New Agency

Where a hiring manager wishes to engage an agency not currently on the approved panel (for example, for a niche or highly specialised role), this requires Procurement approval and execution of a standard Master Service Agreement before any candidate submissions are accepted, to protect the Company's position on fee liability and IP/confidentiality terms.

11.3 Exclusivity and Duplicate Submissions

Where multiple agencies, or an agency and a direct candidate application, submit the same candidate, fee liability is determined based on the timestamp of first submission into the ATS, to avoid double fee liability; this is communicated clearly in agency agreements.

11.4 Agency Performance Review

The TA team reviews agency performance periodically (placement quality, time-to-fill, fee competitiveness) and may adjust the approved panel composition based on this review.

12. Compensation Benchmarking & Internal Equity

12.1 Salary Bands

Each role and grade combination maps to a defined salary band, benchmarked periodically against external market data by the Compensation & Benefits team within HR, ensuring offers are both externally competitive and internally consistent.

12.2 Internal Equity Review

Before extending an offer, HR reviews the proposed compensation against existing employees in comparable roles and grades to avoid material internal equity gaps that could create fairness concerns once the new joiner is onboarded.

12.3 Exception Approval

Any offer proposed outside the standard salary band (for example, to secure a candidate with rare, business-critical skills) requires approval from the department head and the Head of HR, with the rationale documented for future reference.

12.4 Grade and Level Mapping

The TA team and hiring manager agree the appropriate grade/level for a new hire based on the role's scope and the candidate's demonstrated experience during the interview process, using the Company's published career pathway framework referenced in the Employee Handbook, Section 8.4.

13. Probation, Confirmation & Early Attrition

13.1 Cross-Reference

The probation period, monthly check-ins, and confirmation process following hire are governed by the Terms of Employment, Sections 4.1-4.8; this policy focuses on the recruitment and onboarding activities that precede and support a successful probation outcome.

13.2 Early Attrition Analysis

Where a new joiner exits within the first 6 months (whether by resignation or non-confirmation), HR and the TA team conduct a brief root-cause review to identify any recruitment or onboarding process improvement opportunities, distinct from the standard exit interview process described in the Terms of Employment.

13.3 Hiring Manager Accountability

Hiring managers are expected to actively participate in the onboarding plan (Section 7.3) and probation check-ins; a pattern of early attrition concentrated under a specific hiring manager may prompt a broader review of that manager's hiring and onboarding practices by HR.

14. Recruitment Metrics & Reporting

14.1 Standard Metrics

The TA team tracks and reports standard recruitment metrics monthly to the Executive Committee, including time-to-fill, offer acceptance rate, source-of-hire effectiveness, diversity of the candidate pipeline and of hires, and early attrition rate (within 6 months of joining).

14.2 Use of Metrics

These metrics inform sourcing strategy, agency panel decisions, and identification of any systemic issues in the interview or offer process (for example, a consistently low offer acceptance rate for a specific role family may indicate a non-competitive compensation band).

15. Re-Employment of Former Employees ("Boomerang Hires")

15.1 Eligibility

Former employees who left in good standing (per the Terms of Employment, Section 11.9) are eligible to be considered for re-employment through the standard recruitment process described in this policy.

15.2 Streamlined Process

Where the former employee left within the last 12 months and the role is similar to their previous one, the TA team and hiring manager may apply a streamlined interview process, recognising the Company's existing knowledge of the individual's performance and fit, while still completing background verification per Section 4.

15.3 Compensation for Returning Employees

Compensation for a returning employee is benchmarked against the current salary band for the role (Section 12.1) rather than automatically matching or exceeding their previous Narsimha Tech compensation.

16. Glossary

- **ATS:** Applicant Tracking System, the platform used to manage requisitions, candidates, and interview feedback.
- **TA Team:** Talent Acquisition team, responsible for end-to-end recruitment delivery.
- **Requisition:** An approved request to hire for a specific open role.
- **Boomerang Hire:** A former employee re-hired by the Company, as described in Section 15.
- **Salary Band:** The benchmarked compensation range associated with a specific role and grade combination.

17. Internship & Campus-to-Full-Time Conversion

17.1 Internship Programme

Narsimha Tech runs a structured internship programme, typically aligned to academic calendars, providing interns with a defined project, a dedicated mentor, and a structured evaluation at the midpoint and end of the internship.

17.2 Conversion to Full-Time Offer

High-performing interns may be extended a full-time offer ahead of graduation, subject to a successful final evaluation and standard background verification; conversion offers follow the standard offer approval process described in Section 5.1, benchmarked against the relevant campus hire salary band.

17.3 Internship Stipend

Interns receive a fixed monthly stipend (communicated at the time of internship offer) rather than a full compensation package, and are not eligible for the employee benefits described in the Employee Handbook, given their status as interns rather than employees, except where local law requires otherwise.

18. Notice Period Buyout for New Joiners

18.1 Context

Candidates joining from a previous employer mid-way through their notice period sometimes need to "buy out" the remaining notice period to expedite their start date with Narsimha Tech.

18.2 Company Support

Where a candidate's skills are business-critical and a delayed start date would have material business impact, the Company may, at the department head's discretion and subject to HR Director approval, reimburse a portion of the notice period buyout cost incurred by the candidate, documented clearly in the offer letter as a one-time, taxable allowance.

18.3 Clawback

Any notice period buyout reimbursement is subject to a clawback clause if the new employee resigns from Narsimha Tech within 6 months of joining, recovered from the final settlement consistent with the clawback principles described in the Terms of Employment, Section 6.8.

19. Governance & Document Control

11.1 Policy Ownership

This policy is owned by the Head of Talent Acquisition, in partnership with the Head of Human Resources.

11.2 Related Policies

This policy should be read alongside the Terms of Employment (particularly Sections 2-4 on employment categories and probation), the Employee Handbook (Sections 3, 11, and 12), the Code of Conduct & Business Ethics Policy (conflicts of interest), and the IT & Information Security Policy (Joiner-Mover-Leaver process).

11.3 Document Control

Attribute	Detail
Document Owner	Head of Talent Acquisition / Head of Human Resources
Review Frequency	Annual
Last Reviewed	January 2025
Related Documents	Terms of Employment; Employee Handbook; Code of Conduct & Business Ethics Policy; IT & Information Security Policy